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Inventor(s)	Li; Xiaoqian et al.

Barriers for grooves in photonics dies

Abstract

Embodiments disclosed herein include photonics packages. In an embodiment, a photonics package includes a photonics die and a plurality of v-grooves on the photonics die. A barrier structure proximate the plurality of v-grooves.

Inventors: Li; Xiaoqian (Chandler, AZ), Li; Wei (Chandler, AZ), Shaw; Santosh (Chandler, AZ), Huang; Jingyi (Chandler, AZ)

Applicant: Intel Corporation (Santa Clara, CA)

Family ID: 79287619

Assignee: Intel Corporation (Santa Clara, CA)

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Primary Examiner: Henry; Caleb E

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Schwabe, Williamson & Wyatt, P.C.

Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) Embodiments of the present disclosure relate to electronic packages, and more particularly to photonics dies having grooves protected by barrier structures.

BACKGROUND

(2) The microelectronic industry has begun using optical connections as a way to increase bandwidth and performance. Typically, the optical connections include optical fibers that are mounted to v-grooves on the edge of the photonics die. The optical fibers include a pigtail design that is terminated with a multi-channel MT type optical fiber ferrule. Micro lenses can be used to provide a more compact package solution for handling and provide pluggable solutions for customers during system level assembly. However, there are currently no passive alignment features in order to simplify the alignment between the photonics die and the micro lenses. Currently, active alignment processes are needed. Active alignment processes require additional equipment, and is a time consuming process.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1A is a cross-sectional illustration of a photonics die with a v-groove and a lens of a lens array inserted into the v-groove, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (2) FIG. 1B is a plan view illustration of the photonics die and the lens array showing the alignment between the lenses and the v-grooves of the photonics die, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (3) FIG. 2 illustrates a plan view and a cross-sectional view of a photonics package prior to and after fiber attach, respectively, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (4) FIG. 3 illustrates cross-sectional views and plan views of die/substrate bump designs for a metal dam, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (5) FIG. 4 illustrates cross-sectional views and plan views of die/substrate bump designs for a metal dam, in accordance with another embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (6) FIG. 5 illustrates plan views of a polyamide dam plus trench structure around a V-groove area or a polyamide trench around a V-groove area, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (7) FIG. 6 illustrates plan views of copper dam structures proximate V-groove areas, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (8) FIG. 7A is a cross-sectional illustration of a lens array with a pair of alignment pins, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (9) FIG. 7B is a plan view illustration of a lens array interfacing with a photonics die, where the alignment pins are inserted into v-grooves on the photonics die, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (10) FIG. 8A is a cross-sectional illustration of a lens array with a pair of alignment pins that are provided on an opposite surface from the lenses, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (11) FIG. 8B is a plan view illustration of a lens array interfacing with a photonics die, where the alignment pins are inserted into v-grooves on the photonics die, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (12) FIG. 9A is a cross-sectional illustration of a lens array with optical waveguides and a saw-tooth surface for interfacing with v-grooves on a photonics die, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (13) FIG. 9B is a cross-sectional illustration of the lens array showing lenses attached to the waveguides, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (14) FIG. 10A is a cross-sectional illustration of a lens array with an optical fiber passing through a lens housing and a discrete lens on the end of the optical fiber, in accordance with an embodiment.

(15) FIG. 10B is a cross-sectional illustration of a lens array with an optical fiber passing through a lens housing and a lens integrated as part of the optical fiber, in accordance with an embodiment.

(16) FIG. 11 is a perspective view illustration of a photonics die and an L-shaped lens array that interfaces with v-grooves on the photonics die, in accordance with an embodiment.

(17) FIG. 12A is a pair of lens arrays in different orientations, in accordance with an embodiment.

(18) FIG. 12B is a perspective view illustration of a photonics die and lens arrays similar to those shown in FIG. 12A interfacing with v-grooves on the photonics die, in accordance with an embodiment.

(19) FIG. 13 is a cross-sectional illustration of a photonics package with lens arrays attached to the photonics dies, in accordance with an embodiment.

(20) FIG. 14 is a schematic of a computing device built in accordance with an embodiment.

EMBODIMENTS OF THE PRESENT DISCLOSURE

(21) Described herein are photonics dies having grooves protected by barrier structures, in accordance with various embodiments. In the following description, various aspects of the illustrative implementations will be described using terms commonly employed by those skilled in the art to convey the substance of their work to others skilled in the art. However, it will be apparent to those skilled in the art that the present disclosure may be practiced with only some of the described aspects. For purposes of explanation, specific numbers, materials and configurations are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the illustrative implementations. However, it will be apparent to one skilled in the art that the present disclosure may be practiced without the specific details. In other instances, well-known features are omitted or simplified in order not to obscure the illustrative implementations.

(22) Various operations will be described as multiple discrete operations, in turn, in a manner that is most helpful in understanding the present disclosure, however, the order of description should not be construed to imply that these operations are necessarily order dependent. In particular, these operations need not be performed in the order of presentation.

(23) As noted above, lens arrays that are coupled to a photonics die currently require active alignment in order to provide high efficiency coupling. Active alignment requires additional equipment and is a slow process. As such, the active alignment of lens arrays is not compatible with high volume manufacturing (HVM) environments.

(24) Accordingly, embodiments disclosed herein include passive alignment features that can be used to align a lens array with a photonics die. In some embodiments, the lens array can be attached at the die level, which potentially can enable optical testing at the die level before packaging. As such, known good dies can be used in the assembly process in order to improve yield. Additionally, the use of a passively aligned lens array may remove the need to use pigtail fiber connector solutions. As such, package assembly is simplified and pluggable connector solutions may be enabled. In an embodiment, barriers to stop first level interconnect (FLI) epoxy flow to a V-groove zone on a photonics die are described.

(25) Embodiments disclosed herein include various passive alignment features that may be used. In a first embodiment, lenses extending out from a main body of the lens array may be disposed into v-grooves on the photonics die. In other embodiments, dedicated alignment pins on the lens array may be inserted into v-grooves on the photonics die. The alignment pins may be on the same surface as the lenses or on the opposite surface from the lenses. Such embodiments allow for proper alignment of the alignment pins to the lenses even when the alignment pins are on the opposite surface from the lenses. In yet another embodiment, the lens array may include a saw-toothed surface that interfaces with the v-grooves of the photonics die. In some embodiments, a fiber array may be used to slot fibers into the v-grooves of the photonics die. In such embodiments, the lens may be a discrete component attached to the fibers, or the fibers may terminate with a lensed surface. Additional embodiments may include a lens array with an L-shaped body and cylindrical pillars that nest into the v-grooves of the photonics die. Another embodiment may

include a lens array with cylindrical waveguides on one surface and lenses on the opposite surface that are optically coupled with the cylindrical waveguides. The cylindrical waveguides may rest in the v-grooves of the photonics die.

(26) Referring now to FIG. 1A, a cross-sectional illustration of a photonics package **100** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the photonics package **100** may include a photonics die **105**. The photonics die **105** may be a die that is configured to convert optical signals into electrical signals and/or convert electrical signals into optical signals. The photonics die **105** may be coupled to a processor die (not shown) that operates in the electrical regime.

(27) In an embodiment, the photonics die **105** may include a plurality of v-grooves **117**. The v-grooves **117** may be aligned with the spot size converter (not shown) that interfaces with an optical waveguide of the photonics die **105**. The spot size converter may be provided at an end surface of the v-groove **117** (i.e., the left end of the v-groove **117** in FIG. 1A).

(28) In an embodiment, the photonics package **100** may further include a lens array. The lens array may include an optically clear body **120** and a plurality of lenses **122**. The lens array may be formed of glass or an optically clear polymer material. The lenses **122** may be formed with an etching process or the optically clear body **120** and the lenses **122** may be formed with a molding process. The lenses **122** may extend out from the optically clear body **120**.

(29) As shown, the lenses **122** may sit in the v-grooves **117** of the photonics die **105**. That is, the lenses **122** are passively aligned with the spot size converter of the photonics die **105** by the v-grooves **117**. As such, there is no need for active alignment of the lenses **122**. The spacing of the lenses **122** with respect to each other can be tightly controlled by the etching or molding process used to form the lenses **122**, and the proper alignment with the photonics die **105** is provided by the structure of the v-grooves **117**.

(30) In an embodiment, the lens array may be attached to the photonics die **105** at the die level.

Such assembly allows for the photonics die **105** to be tested at an early point of assembly.

Therefore, subsequent assembly processes may be able to proceed with known good dies. The use of known good die assembly improves the overall yield of the assembled product.

(31) Referring now to FIG. 1B, a plan view illustration of the photonics package **100** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. As shown, a plurality of lenses **122** are provided along a length of the lens body **120**. While six lenses **122** are shown, it is to be appreciated that the lens array may include any number of lenses **122** in order to match the design of the photonics die **105**. For example, the lens array may include eight lenses **122**, twelve lenses **122**, sixteen lenses **122**, or twenty-four lenses **122**. In an embodiment, the lenses **122** may be provided at the end of cylindrical posts **123**. The cylindrical posts **123** increases the length of the lens array that interfaces with the v-grooves **117**. In other embodiments, the lenses **122** may be directly protruding from the lens body **120**, and the cylindrical posts **123** may be omitted.

(32) In an embodiment, the lens array is brought towards the photonics die **105**, as indicated by the arrow. The lenses **122** then slot into the v-grooves **117** on the photonics die **105**. In an embodiment, the lenses **122** and the cylindrical posts **123** may have a total length that is less than a length of the v-grooves **117**. In other embodiments, the lenses **122** and the cylindrical posts **123** may have a length that is substantially equal to the length of the v-grooves **117** or even a length that is greater than the length of the v-grooves **117**. As shown, the number of v-grooves **117** may be equal to the number of lenses **122**. That is, each v-groove **117** accommodates a single one of the lenses **122**.

(33) In accordance with one or more embodiments described herein, barriers to inhibit or stop first level interconnect (FLI) epoxy flow to a V-groove zone on a photonics die are described. To provide context, a V-groove feature can be fabricated on photonics Si to enable fiber passive alignment during fiber attach. In some photonics package architectures, a photonics die is overhanging on the substrate edge. The V-groove can subsequently be accessed by a fiber array. A fabrication process flow can include chip attach, then FLI underfill, then integrated heat spreader (HIS) attach, then ball attach, and then fiber attach with optical epoxy to fill the fiber tip to Si

waveguide gap. With such a process flow, in some embodiments, it may need to be ensured the FLI underfill material does not overflow to the V-groove region, since a different epoxy may need to be used in the V-groove zone for optical purposes.

(34) FIG. 2 illustrates a plan view and a cross-sectional view of a photonics package prior to and after fiber attach, respectively, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(35) Referring to FIG. 2, a photonics package **200** or **250** includes a substrate **202** having one or more photonics dies **204** thereon. Each of the photonics dies **204** includes a plurality of V-grooves **206** surrounded by a keep out zone (KOZ) **208**. A field programmable gate array (FPGA) die **212** is also coupled to the substrate **202**. An integrated heat spreader (HIS) **210** is coupled to the FPGA die **212** and to the photonics dies **204**. The substrate **202** is coupled to a board **214**. A fiber connector **216** is inserted into the V-grooves **206** of one of the photonics dies **204**.

(36) A state-of-the-art approach involves dispensing barrier materials either on the Si (**204**) or on the substrate **202** to control the epoxy flow. The width and position control of the barrier materials dispense may not be precise, and thus may require a large KOZ **208** for the process. In accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, barrier concepts are described herein including the fabrication of different dam or trench features from a substrate or a die side through a substrate manufacturing process or a bumping process. Both substrate manufacturing and bumping processes may have improved dimension/position control which can reduce the distance need between the bump area and the V-groove area. In one embodiment, implementation of embodiments described herein can provide a cost saving opportunity for photonics die designs. Several architectures and process flows are described below to demonstrate wafer/panel level fiber connector attach concepts.

(37) In a first aspect, a special C4 solder joint or joints is used as a dam. In an embodiment, a special solder joints dam fabricated in C4, with same metal layers as core bumps but different geometry, through either thermal compression bonding (TCB) or a mass reflow process that is used to form regular core bump joints.

(38) FIG. 3 illustrates cross-sectional views and plan views of die/substrate bump designs for a metal dam, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(39) Referring to part (a) of FIG. 3, a photonics package **300** includes a die **304** coupled to a substrate **302**. The substrate **302** and die **304** are coupled in a core bump region **310** by soldered substrate bumps **306** and soldered die bumps **308**. A dam region **312** includes a soldered substrate bump line **322** coupled to a soldered die bump line **320**. Referring to part (b) of FIG. 3, a photonics package **350** includes a die **354** coupled to a substrate **352**. The substrate **352** and die **354** are coupled in a core bump region **360** by substrate solder structures **356** and non-soldered die bumps **358**. A dam region **362** includes a substrate solder line **372** coupled to a die bump line **370**.

(40) Referring again to FIG. 3, in an embodiment, a substrate/die design for a metal dam is provided for both conventional and all solder on substrate (ASOS) structures. For both cases, a copper layer and solder layer on both die and substrate are fabricated in same process operations as regulator core bumps. The dam can be formed in a same assembly process as regular solder bump joints. In one embodiment, the only difference between the dam region joint and regular core bumps are their geometry.

(41) FIG. 4 illustrates cross-sectional views and plan views of die/substrate bump designs for a metal dam, in accordance with another embodiment of the present disclosure.

(42) Referring to part (a) of FIG. 4, a photonics package **400** includes a die **404** coupled to a substrate **402**. The substrate **402** and die **404** are coupled in a core bump region **410** by soldered substrate bumps **406** and soldered die bumps **408**. A dam region **412** includes a soldered substrate bump array **422** coupled to a soldered die bump array **420**. Referring to part (b) of FIG. 4, a photonics package **450** includes a die **454** coupled to a substrate **452**. The substrate **452** and die **454** are coupled in a core bump region **460** by substrate solder structures **456** and non-soldered die bumps **458**. A dam region **462** includes a substrate solder array **472** coupled to a die bump array

(43) Referring again to FIG. 4, in an embodiment, a dam includes individual bumps versus a continuous and a single joint as described in FIG. 3. However, in one embodiment, the individual bumps have a finer pitch compared to regular core bumps. Thus, the individual bumps in the design of FIG. 4 can form bridged joints during TCB or mass reflow, and there is a possibility of tiny holes between those joints. However, as long as the hole is small enough to prevent epoxy spreading out of KOZ, such special C4 solder joints may be sufficient to act as a dam.

(44) In a second aspect, a special polyamide or copper construct is used to act as a barrier for epoxy/materials spread. In an embodiment, dam features are fabricated from either Polyamide (PI) or Copper (Cu). Both such materials can be coated or plated during a bumping process on a Silicon die/chip. In a first scheme, a structure is built either in the PI blanket or fabricated from PI. If a PI blanket is not required in the KOZ area (area between the bump field and V-groove or any feature where epoxy spread is undesirable), such as described in association with part (a) of FIG. 5, then a construction that of combination of dam and trench (or can be referred to as a double sided dam) is created with PI lithography around the feature as a barrier for epoxy spreading in that location. On the other hand, if PI is needed in the KOZ area, such as described in association with part (b) of FIG. 5, then PI lithography can be used to develop a trench around the V-groove or any other area to prevent epoxy spread to that area. In an embodiment, either of the double-sided dam or trench can be created near the bump field area as barrier and slow the epoxy/or other materials spread to undesirable region.

(45) FIG. 5 illustrates plan views of a polyamide dam plus trench structure around a V-groove area or a polyamide trench around a V-groove area, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(46) Referring to part (a) of FIG. 5, a photonics die **500** includes an exposed silicon region **502** and a core and microbump region **504**. One or more V-groove regions **506** are surrounded by corresponding polyamide dam plus trench structures **508**. Referring to part (b) of FIG. 5, a photonics die **550** includes a PI coating **558** on a silicon region **552**. The photonics die **550** also includes a core and microbump region **554**. One or more V-groove regions **556** are surrounded by corresponding polyamide trench structures **560**. It is to be appreciated that, in other embodiments (not depicted), a single dam, a single dam plus trench or a single trench structure surrounds two or more V-groove regions.

(47) In a second aspect, a copper (Cu) construct can be fabricated as a barrier feature for epoxy or other materials. Copper plating is part of the bumping process to plate a Cu pillar for bump/interconnect. In FIG. 6, a Cu structure is described for obstructing or slowing an epoxy spread. In one case, Cu walls are fabricated near the bump field region to slow the speed of epoxy spread which is not only for epoxy spreading to undesired area (in this case V-groove region) but can potentially save the real estate between a bump field and a V-groove region which can otherwise potentially effectively reduce the die area (if desired). In another case, a Cu wall is fabricated as a dam as C-shaped around the V-groove (or any area) as a barrier for epoxy or any other materials to spread over the region. In an embodiment, if there are aggressive KOZ requirements, a combination of both can be used to both slow and prevent epoxy or any other materials spread. In some embodiments, both PI and Cu can be combined where needed as both can be fabricated as part of a bumping process and can be fabricated without disrupting the regular process.

(48) FIG. 6 illustrates plan views of Cu dam structures proximate V-groove areas, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(49) Referring to part (a) of FIG. 6, a photonics die **600** includes an exposed silicon region **602** and a core and microbump region **604**. One or more V-groove regions **606** are protected by corresponding copper wall structures **608**. Referring to part (b) of FIG. 6, a photonics die **650** includes an exposed silicon region **652** and a core and microbump region **654**. One or more V-

groove regions **656** are surrounded by corresponding Cu dam structures **658**.

(50) Referring now to FIG. 7A, a cross-sectional illustration of a lens array is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. In an embodiment, the lens array includes a main body **720** and a plurality of lenses **722** extending out from the main body **720**. The main body **720** and the lenses **722** may be an optically clear material, such as glass or an optically clear polymer. The main body **720** may have a first surface **726** and a second surface **727** that is opposite from the first surface **726**. In an embodiment, the lenses **722** may extend out from the first surface **726**.

(51) In an embodiment, the lens array may further include alignment pins **725**. The alignment pins **725** may also extend out from the first surface **726**. That is, the alignment pins **725** and the lenses **722** may extend out from the same surface of the main body **720**. In an embodiment, while shown as a different shading, it is to be appreciated that the alignment pins **725**, the lenses **722**, and the main body **720** may be formed from a single material as a monolithic structure. The alignment pins **725** and the lenses **722** may be formed with an etching process. Since the alignment pins **725** and the lenses **722** are on the same first surface **726** of the main body, the alignment between the alignment pins **725** and the lenses **722** may be tightly controlled. As such, when the alignment pins **725** are properly aligned with the photonics die (not shown in FIG. 7A), the lenses **722** will also be properly aligned with the photonics die.

(52) In FIG. 7A, four lenses **722** are shown. However, it is to be appreciated that the lens array may include any number of lenses **722** in order to accommodate the photonics die. The alignment pins **725** are provided on opposite ends of the lenses **722**. That is, a first alignment pin **725** is on the left side of the lenses **722**, and a second alignment pin **725** is on the right side of the lenses **722**. In other embodiments, more than two alignment pins **725** may be used.

(53) Referring now to FIG. 7B, a plan view illustration of a photonics package **700** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. As shown, a lens array is coupled to a photonics die **705**. The lens array may be substantially similar to the lens array describe above with respect to FIG. 7A. For example, alignment pins **725** and lenses **722** may extend out from the same surface of the main body **720**. In an embodiment, the alignment pins **725** may be inserted into v-grooves **716** on the photonics die **705**. The v-grooves **716** may be for alignment purposes only. For example, the v-grooves **716** may not necessarily function as part of the optical path for optical signals to/from the photonics die **705**. The v-grooves **716** may be a different dimension than the v-grooves **717** (which are used for optical signaling) in some embodiments. In other embodiments, the v-grooves **716** may be substantially the same dimension as the v-grooves **717**. In an embodiment, the lenses **722** may remain outside of the v-grooves **717**, as shown in FIG. 7B. In other embodiments, the lens array may be inserted so that the alignment pins **725** are inserted into the v-grooves **716**, and the lenses **722** are inserted into the v-grooves **717**. In accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, the photonics die **705** includes a barrier structure proximate the v-grooves **716** and/or **717**, where exemplary such barrier structures are described above in association with FIGS. 3-6.

(54) Referring now to FIG. 8A, a cross-sectional illustration of a lens array is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. In an embodiment, the lens array includes a main body **820**. The main body **820** has a first surface **826** and a second surface **827** opposite from the first surface **826**. A plurality of lenses **822** may extend out from the first surface **826**, and alignment pins **825** may extend out from the second surface **826**. That is, the lenses **822** and the alignment pins **825** may be on opposite surfaces of the main body **820**.

(55) In an embodiment, the alignment pins **825**, the lenses **822**, and the main body **820** may be formed from a single material and be a monolithic structure. For example, an etching or molding process of an optically clear material (e.g., glass or an optically clear polymer) may be used to form the lens array. In an embodiment where an etching process is used, a first etching process may be used to form the lenses **822**, and a second etching process may be used to form the alignment pins **825**. In such instances, careful control of the two etching processes may be necessary in order to

maintain proper alignment between the alignment pins **825** and the lenses **822**.

(56) In FIG. **8A**, four lenses **822** are shown. However, it is to be appreciated that any number of lenses **822** may be included on the lens array in order to accommodate a given design of the photonics die (not shown in FIG. **8A**). Similarly, while two alignment pins **825** are shown, it is to be appreciated that any number of alignment pins **825** may be used. In the particular embodiment shown in FIG. **8A**, a first alignment pin **825** is on a left side of the lenses **822** and a second alignment pin **825** is on a right side of the lenses **822**.

(57) Referring now to FIG. **8B**, a plan view illustration of a photonics package **800** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. The photonics package **800** includes a photonics die **805** and lens array. The lens array may be substantially similar to the lens array described with respect to FIG. **8A**. As shown, the alignment pins **825** may be inserted into v-grooves **816**. The lenses **822** may face away from the photonics die **805** since they are on the opposite surface of the main body **820** from the alignment pins **825**.

(58) In an embodiment, the photonics package **800** may include v-grooves **817**. However, the v-grooves **817** may remain unfilled since the lenses **822** are on the opposite face of the main body **820**. In other embodiments, the v-grooves **817** may be omitted, and the spot size converter may be provided at the edge of the photonics die **805**. In the illustrated embodiment, the main body **820** is spaced away from an edge of the photonics die **805**. However, in other embodiments, the main body **820** may be provided flush against the edge of the photonics die **805**. In accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, the photonics die **805** includes a barrier structure proximate the v-grooves **816** and/or **817**, where exemplary such barrier structures are described above in association with FIGS. **3-6**.

(59) Referring now to FIG. **9A**, a cross-sectional illustration of a lens array is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. In an embodiment, the lens array includes a main body **940**. In an embodiment, a plurality of waveguides **941** are embedded in the main body **940**. The number of waveguides **941** may be equal to the number of v-grooves in a photonics die (not shown in FIG. **9A**). In an embodiment, the main body **940** may also include a saw-toothed surface **942**. The saw-toothed surface **942** may interface with the v-grooves of the photonics die in order to properly align the waveguides **941** to the spot size converter. In the illustrated embodiment, the saw-toothed surface **942** is an angular surface, but in other embodiments, the saw-toothed surface **942** may be rounded. In accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, the photonics die includes a barrier structure proximate the v-grooves, where exemplary such barrier structures are described above in association with FIGS. **3-6**.

(60) Referring now to FIG. **9B**, a cross-sectional illustration of a lens array is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. As shown, the waveguides **941** terminate at a lens **922**. The lenses **922** may be discrete components that are attached to the waveguides **941**. In other embodiments, the lenses **922** may be integrated with the waveguides **941** as a monolithic structure. In an embodiment, the lens array may be inserted into the v-grooves so that the lenses **922** are facing away from the spot size converter.

(61) Referring now to FIG. **10A**, a cross-sectional illustration of a photonics package **1000** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the photonics package **1000** includes a photonics die **1005** and a lens array. The photonics die **1005** may include v-grooves **1017**. The lens array may include a fiber housing **1050**. The fiber housing **1050** houses an optical fiber **1051**. The optical fiber **1051** extends out from the fiber housing **1050** and sits in the v-groove **1017**. In an embodiment, the fiber housing **1050** secures together a plurality of optical fibers **1051** and allows for easy insertion into the v-grooves **1017**. As such, each individual fiber does not need to be aligned and inserted into the v-grooves **1017**. In accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, the photonics die **1005** includes a barrier structure proximate the v-grooves **1017**, where exemplary such barrier structures are described above in association with FIGS. **3-6**.

(62) In an embodiment, the optical fiber **1051** may terminate at a lens **1022**. In the embodiment shown in FIG. **10A**, the lens **1022** is a discrete component from the optical fiber **1051**. However, as shown in FIG. **10B**, the lens **1022** may be integrated as part of the optical fiber **1051**. That is, the optical fiber **1051** itself can be formed into a lensed surface.

(63) Referring now to FIG. **11**, a perspective view illustration of a photonics package **1100** is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. In an embodiment, the photonics package **1100** includes a photonics die **1105** with v-grooves **1117**. One or more lens arrays may be coupled to the v-grooves **1117** of the photonics die **1105**. As shown in FIG. **11**, a first lens array is coupled to the v-grooves **1117** and a second lens array is oriented to show the structure of the lens array. In accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, the photonics die **1105** includes a barrier structure proximate the v-grooves **1117**, where exemplary such barrier structures are described above in association with FIGS. **3-6**.

(64) As shown, the lens array may include a body **1120** with an L-shaped cross-section. Cylindrical pillars **1123** may extend out from a surface of the body **1120**. The cylindrical pillars **1123** may be sized to fit into the v-grooves **1117** of the photonics die **1105**. Ends of the cylindrical pillars **1123** may be lenses **1122**. By sitting the cylindrical pillars **1123** into the v-grooves **1117**, the lenses **1122** become properly aligned.

(65) In an embodiment, the lens array may be formed from a single optically clear material. For example, a glass or an optically clear polymer may be used. The cylindrical pillars **1123** and the lenses **1122** may be formed with an etching process. Particularly only a single surface of the lens array needs to be etched in some embodiments.

(66) Referring now to FIG. **12A**, a pair of lens arrays are shown, in accordance with an embodiment. The two lens arrays shown are the same, but are oriented in different directions in order to see all of the features clearly. As shown in the bottom lens array, cylindrical waveguides **1281** are provided on a recessed surface of the main body **1220**. As shown in the top lens array, cylindrical waveguides **1282** that end with lenses **1222** are shown. The cylindrical waveguides **1282** and **1281** may be optically coupled together. That is, an optical signal can propagate from the cylindrical waveguide **1281** to the cylindrical waveguide **1282**, and ultimately to the lens **1222**.

(67) In an embodiment, the lens arrays may be fabricated with an etching process or a molding process. In an etching process, a first etch may be used to form the cylindrical waveguides **1281** and a second etching process may be used to form the cylindrical waveguides **1282** on the opposite surface of the main body **1220**. A molding process may provide a more tight alignment between the cylindrical waveguides **1281** and the cylindrical waveguides **1282**.

(68) Referring now to FIG. **12B**, a perspective view illustration of a photonics package **1200** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. The photonics package **1200** includes a photonics die **1205** with v-grooves **1217**. A first lens array is shown on the photonics package **1200** and a second lens array is oriented to see the structure that interfaces with the v-grooves **1217**. As shown, the cylindrical waveguides **1281** align with the v-grooves **1217**. As such, a passive alignment is provided. In accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, the photonics die **1205** includes a barrier structure proximate the v-grooves **1217**, where exemplary such barrier structures are described above in association with FIGS. **3-6**.

(69) Referring now to FIG. **13**, a cross-sectional illustration of a photonics system **1390** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the photonics system **1390** may include a board **1391**, such as a printed circuit board (PCB). The board **1391** may be coupled to a package substrate **1393** by interconnects **1392**. The interconnects **1392** are shown as solder balls, but it is to be appreciated that any interconnect architecture may be used, such as, but not limited to, socketing architectures. In an embodiment, a processor **1395** and photonics dies **1305** may be coupled to the package substrate **1393** by interconnects **1389**. In an embodiment, the photonics dies **1305** may be communicatively coupled to the processor **1395** by embedded bridges **1394** or by any other high density interconnect architecture. An integrated heat spreader (IHS) **1396** may be thermally

coupled to the backside surfaces of the photonics dies **1305** and the processor **1395**.

(70) In an embodiment, an array of lenses **1322** may be provided along edges of the photonics dies **1305**. The lenses **1322** may be passively aligned to the optical path of the photonics dies **1305** using any of the lens array architectures described in greater detail above. For example, portions of the lens array may interface with v-grooves of the photonics dies **1305**. In accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, the photonics die **1305** includes a barrier structure proximate the v-grooves, where exemplary such barrier structures are described above in association with FIGS. 3-6.

(71) In an embodiment, an external plug **1397** may interface with the lenses **1322**. Any plugging architecture may be used. The external plug **1397** may include a second lens **1398** that interfaces with an optical cable **1399**. The lenses **1322** and the lenses **1398** may be collimating lenses to provide expanded beam coupling. Expanded beam coupling eases the alignment tolerances and provides for improved optical coupling.

(72) FIG. 14 illustrates a computing device **1400** in accordance with one implementation of the disclosure. The computing device **1400** houses a board **1402**. The board **1402** may include a number of components, including but not limited to a processor **1404** and at least one communication chip **1406**. The processor **1404** is physically and electrically coupled to the board **1402**. In some implementations the at least one communication chip **1406** is also physically and electrically coupled to the board **1402**. In further implementations, the communication chip **1406** is part of the processor **1404**.

(73) These other components include, but are not limited to, volatile memory (e.g., DRAM), non-volatile memory (e.g., ROM), flash memory, a graphics processor, a digital signal processor, a crypto processor, a chipset, an antenna, a display, a touchscreen display, a touchscreen controller, a battery, an audio codec, a video codec, a power amplifier, a global positioning system (GPS) device, a compass, an accelerometer, a gyroscope, a speaker, a camera, and a mass storage device (such as hard disk drive, compact disk (CD), digital versatile disk (DVD), and so forth).

(74) The communication chip **1406** enables wireless communications for the transfer of data to and from the computing device **1400**. The term “wireless” and its derivatives may be used to describe circuits, devices, systems, methods, techniques, communications channels, etc., that may communicate data through the use of modulated electromagnetic radiation through a non-solid medium. The term does not imply that the associated devices do not contain any wires, although in some embodiments they might not. The communication chip **1406** may implement any of a number of wireless standards or protocols, including but not limited to Wi-Fi (IEEE 802.11 family), WiMAX (IEEE 802.16 family), IEEE 802.20, long term evolution (LTE), Ev-DO, HSPA+, HSDPA+, HSUPA+, EDGE, GSM, GPRS, CDMA, TDMA, DECT, Bluetooth, derivatives thereof, as well as any other wireless protocols that are designated as 3G, 4G, 5G, and beyond. The computing device **1400** may include a plurality of communication chips **1406**. For instance, a first communication chip **1406** may be dedicated to shorter range wireless communications such as Wi-Fi and Bluetooth and a second communication chip **1406** may be dedicated to longer range wireless communications such as GPS, EDGE, GPRS, CDMA, WiMAX, LTE, Ev-DO, and others.

(75) The processor **1404** of the computing device **1400** includes an integrated circuit die packaged within the processor **1404**. In some implementations of the disclosure, the integrated circuit die of the processor may be part of a photonics system that includes a passively aligned lens array coupled with a photonics die, in accordance with embodiments described herein. The term “processor” may refer to any device or portion of a device that processes electronic data from registers and/or memory to transform that electronic data into other electronic data that may be stored in registers and/or memory.

(76) The communication chip **1406** also includes an integrated circuit die packaged within the communication chip **1406**. In accordance with another implementation of the disclosure, the integrated circuit die of the communication chip may be part of a photonics system that includes a

passively aligned lens array coupled with a photonics die, in accordance with embodiments described herein.

(77) The above description of illustrated implementations of the disclosure, including what is described in the Abstract, is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the disclosure to the precise forms disclosed. While specific implementations of, and examples for, the disclosure are described herein for illustrative purposes, various equivalent modifications are possible within the scope of the disclosure, as those skilled in the relevant art will recognize.

(78) These modifications may be made to the disclosure in light of the above detailed description. The terms used in the following claims should not be construed to limit the disclosure to the specific implementations disclosed in the specification and the claims. Rather, the scope of the disclosure is to be determined entirely by the following claims, which are to be construed in accordance with established doctrines of claim interpretation. Example 1: a photonics package, comprising: a photonics die; a plurality of v-grooves on the photonics die; and a barrier structure proximate the plurality of v-grooves. Example 2: the photonics package of Example 1, further comprising a lens array optically coupled to a spot size converter on the photonics die, wherein the lens array comprises: a main body; and a plurality of lenses extending out from the main body. Example 3: the photonics package of Example 2, wherein individual ones of the plurality of lenses are disposed in different ones of the plurality of v-grooves. Example 4: the photonics package of Example 2 or Example 3, wherein the lens array further comprises: a pair of alignment posts extending out from the main body. Example 5: the photonics package of Example 4, wherein the alignment posts and the plurality of lenses extend out from a first surface of the main body. Example 6: the photonics package of Example 4, wherein the alignment posts extend out from a first surface of the main body, and wherein the plurality of lenses extend out from a second surface of the main body. Example 7: the photonics package of Example 4, wherein the alignment posts are disposed in the v-grooves. Example 8: the photonics package of Examples 2-7, further comprising: a plurality of waveguides extending through the main body, wherein each waveguide is optically coupled to one of the plurality of lenses; and a saw-tooth pattern on a bottom surface of the main body. Example 9: the photonics package of Example 8, wherein the saw-tooth pattern sits into the plurality of v-grooves on the photonics die. Example 10: the photonics package of Examples 2-9, wherein the main body is L-shaped. Example 11: the photonics package of Example 10, wherein cylindrical pillars extend out from a surface of the main body, and wherein the plurality of lenses are at ends of the cylindrical pillars. Example 12: the photonics package of Example 11, wherein the cylindrical pillars are set into the plurality of v-grooves on the photonics die. Example 13: the photonics package of Examples 2-12, further comprising: cylindrical ridges on a first surface of the main body; and a recessed surface on a second surface of the main body, wherein the lenses are on the recessed surface. Example 14: the photonics package of Example 13, wherein the cylindrical ridges are set into the plurality of v-grooves on the photonics die. Example 15: a photonics package, comprising: a photonics die; a plurality of v-grooves in the photonics die; a barrier structure proximate the plurality of v-grooves; and a lens array optically coupled to a spot size converter on the photonics die, wherein the lens array comprises: a fiber housing; a plurality of optical fibers in the fiber housing; and a plurality of lenses at an end of the optical fibers. Example 16: the photonics package of Example 15, wherein the plurality of optical fibers are set into the plurality of v-grooves on the photonics die. Example 17: the photonics package of Example 15 or Example 16, wherein the plurality of lenses are discrete bodies from the plurality of optical fibers. Example 18: the photonics package of Examples 15-17, wherein the plurality of lenses are fabricated as part of the plurality of optical fibers. Example 19: a photonics system, comprising: a board; a package substrate coupled to the board; a processor on the package substrate; a photonics die on the package substrate and communicatively coupled to the processor, the photonics die comprising a barrier structure proximate a plurality of v-grooves; and a lens array coupled to an edge of the photonics die. Example 20: the photonics system of Example 19, wherein the lens array

comprises: a main body; and a plurality of lenses extending out from the main body. Example 21: the photonics system of Example 20, wherein individual ones of the plurality of lenses are disposed in different ones of the plurality of v-grooves. Example 22: the photonics system of Examples 19-21, wherein the lens array further comprises: a pair of alignment posts extending out from the main body.

Claims

1. A photonics package, comprising: a photonics die; a plurality of v-grooves on the photonics die; a barrier structure proximate the plurality of v-grooves; and an underfill material, wherein the barrier structure is between the underfill material and the plurality of v-grooves, and wherein the barrier structure inhibits the underfill material from filling the plurality of v-grooves.
2. The photonics package of claim 1, further comprising: a lens array optically coupled to a spot size converter on the photonics die, wherein the lens array comprises: a main body; and a plurality of lenses extending out from the main body.
3. The photonics package of claim 2, wherein individual ones of the plurality of lenses are disposed in different ones of the plurality of v-grooves.
4. The photonics package of claim 2, wherein the lens array further comprises: a pair of alignment posts extending out from the main body.
5. The photonics package of claim 4, wherein the alignment posts and the plurality of lenses extend out from a first surface of the main body.
6. The photonics package of claim 4, wherein the alignment posts extend out from a first surface of the main body, and wherein the plurality of lenses extend out from a second surface of the main body.
7. The photonics package of claim 4, wherein the alignment posts are disposed in the v-grooves.
8. The photonics package of claim 2, further comprising: a plurality of waveguides extending through the main body, wherein each waveguide is optically coupled to one of the plurality of lenses; and a saw-tooth pattern on a bottom surface of the main body.
9. The photonics package of claim 8, wherein the saw-tooth pattern sits into the plurality of v-grooves on the photonics die.
10. The photonics package of claim 2, wherein the main body is L-shaped.
11. The photonics package of claim 10, wherein a plurality of cylindrical pillars extend out from a surface of the main body, and wherein the plurality of lenses are at ends of the plurality of cylindrical pillars.
12. The photonics package of claim 11, wherein the cylindrical pillars are set into the plurality of v-grooves on the photonics die.
13. The photonics package of claim 2, further comprising: cylindrical ridges on a first surface of the main body; and a recessed surface on a second surface of the main body, wherein the lenses are on the recessed surface.
14. The photonics package of claim 13, wherein the cylindrical ridges are set into the plurality of v-grooves on the photonics die.
15. A photonics package, comprising: a photonics die; a plurality of v-grooves in the photonics die; a barrier structure proximate the plurality of v-grooves; an underfill material, wherein the barrier structure is between the underfill material and the plurality of v-grooves, and wherein the barrier structure inhibits the underfill material from filling the plurality of v-grooves; and a lens array optically coupled to a spot size converter on the photonics die, wherein the lens array comprises: a fiber housing; a plurality of optical fibers in the fiber housing; and a plurality of lenses at an end of the optical fibers.
16. The photonics package of claim 15, wherein the plurality of optical fibers are set into the plurality of v-grooves on the photonics die.

17. The photonics package of claim 15, wherein the plurality of lenses are discrete bodies from the plurality of optical fibers.
18. The photonics package of claim 15, wherein the plurality of lenses are fabricated as part of the plurality of optical fibers.
19. A photonics system, comprising: a board; a package substrate coupled to the board; a processor on the package substrate; a photonics die on the package substrate and communicatively coupled to the processor, the photonics die comprising a barrier structure proximate a plurality of v-grooves; an underfill material, wherein the barrier structure is between the underfill material and the plurality of v-grooves, and wherein the barrier structure inhibits the underfill material from filling the plurality of v-grooves; and a lens array coupled to an edge of the photonics die.
20. The photonics system of claim 19, wherein the lens array comprises: a main body; and a plurality of lenses extending out from the main body.
21. The photonics system of claim 20, wherein individual ones of the plurality of lenses are disposed in different ones of the plurality of v-grooves.
22. The photonics system of claim 20, wherein the lens array further comprises: a pair of alignment posts extending out from the main body.
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